WOMEN'S ENGINEERING COLLEGE

DEPARTMENT OF INFORMATION SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

PROJECT REPORT

Submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the degree of

BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY

COVID-19 DATA ANALYSIS DASHBOARD

submitted by

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2024 - 2028

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CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background and Motivation

The COVID-19 pandemic, caused by the novel coronavirus SARS-CoV-2, emerged in late 2019 and rapidly evolved into one of the most severe global health crises in modern history. Within months, it spread across borders, overwhelming healthcare systems and disrupting economies, education, and daily life across every continent. The sheer scale and speed of the pandemic generated an unprecedented volume of public health data—data that, if properly analyzed, holds the key to understanding the virus's behavior and guiding effective responses.

Governments, research institutions, and international health organizations began collecting and publishing daily records of confirmed cases, recoveries, and fatalities across countries and regions. However, the availability of data alone is not sufficient. Raw numbers presented in spreadsheets or static tables are difficult for most people to interpret, especially when dealing with millions of records spanning multiple countries and years. There was a clear and growing need for tools that could transform these complex datasets into something visually accessible and immediately meaningful.

This project was motivated by the desire to bridge the gap between raw pandemic data and public understanding. By building an interactive dashboard using Python and modern data visualization libraries, the project aims to empower users—regardless of their technical background—to explore and understand COVID-19 trends in a clear, engaging, and informative way.

1.2 Problem Statement

Despite the wide availability of COVID-19 datasets from credible sources such as the Johns Hopkins University repository, a significant challenge remains: these datasets are large, complex, and not easily interpretable in their raw form. A typical user—whether a student, a journalist, or a concerned citizen—lacks the programming expertise required to query, filter, and analyze such data independently.

Existing solutions are often too technical, poorly designed for non-expert users, or limited in their ability to allow customized exploration of the data. There is a lack of simple, interactive platforms where users can select specific countries, filter by date ranges, and observe meaningful trends without requiring programming knowledge or statistical expertise.

This project addresses the problem by developing a user-friendly web-based dashboard that processes, analyzes, and visualizes COVID-19 data in real time. The system eliminates the technical barrier between the data and its audience, enabling intuitive exploration of infection trends, recovery patterns, and mortality rates across different countries and time periods.

1.3 Objectives of the Study

The primary objectives of this project are as follows:

- To collect and preprocess COVID-19 data from the Johns Hopkins University public repository, ensuring accuracy, completeness, and consistency of the dataset.
- To perform exploratory data analysis (EDA) to uncover key patterns, trends, and anomalies in the global spread of the pandemic.
- To develop interactive and informative visualizations—including line graphs, bar charts, and comparative plots—that clearly communicate the progression of COVID-19 across different regions.
- To build a fully functional, user-friendly dashboard using Streamlit that allows users to filter data by country and date range without any programming knowledge.
- To demonstrate how data visualization can serve as a powerful tool for making complex public health data accessible and understandable to a general audience.

1.4 Scope of the Project

This project focuses exclusively on the analysis and visualization of historical COVID-19 data. It does not incorporate any machine learning models, predictive algorithms, or forecasting components. The scope is intentionally bounded to ensure a clear and well-executed outcome within the constraints of time and resources.

The dataset used spans the period from the early months of the pandemic through recent records, covering multiple countries and regions worldwide. The analysis includes three core metrics: confirmed cases, recovered cases, and deaths. The dashboard supports country-level filtering and time-range selection, giving users the flexibility to focus on specific geographies and timeframes.

The project is developed entirely using open-source Python tools—Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, Seaborn, and Streamlit—and is designed to run as a local web application. Real-time data fetching, cloud deployment, and mobile optimization are outside the current scope but represent potential directions for future development.

CHAPTER 2: LITERATURE REVIEW

The COVID-19 pandemic generated an enormous volume of data across healthcare systems, governments, and international organizations worldwide. This surge in data prompted a wave of research focused on analyzing, modeling, and visualizing the spread of the virus. This chapter reviews

significant contributions in the field of COVID-19 data analysis, examines existing predictive and analytical approaches, compares commonly used machine learning models, and highlights the limitations that motivated the development of this project.

2.1 Overview of COVID-19 Data Analysis Techniques

From the earliest days of the pandemic, researchers recognized the importance of data-driven approaches to monitor and understand viral spread. A wide range of analytical techniques has been applied to COVID-19 datasets, each serving a distinct purpose depending on the nature of the data and the questions being asked.

Time-series analysis became one of the most widely adopted techniques, enabling researchers to track daily changes in confirmed cases, deaths, and recoveries over time. Studies by Dong et al. (2020), who developed the Johns Hopkins University COVID-19 tracking dashboard, demonstrated the effectiveness of simple yet well-structured visualizations in communicating real-time pandemic data to the global public. Their work laid the foundation for much of the subsequent research and tooling in this domain.

Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA) has also been extensively used to uncover patterns in pandemic datasets. Researchers applied statistical summaries, distribution analysis, and correlation mapping to understand how different variables—such as population density, healthcare capacity, and government response measures—relate to case counts and mortality rates. Studies such as those published on platforms like Kaggle and ResearchGate demonstrated that even basic EDA, when applied thoughtfully, could yield powerful insights about the pace of infection and effectiveness of containment strategies.

Geographic and regional analysis formed another important pillar of COVID-19 research. Heatmaps, choropleth maps, and cluster visualizations were used to identify hotspots, trace the movement of the virus across regions, and compare national and sub-national outbreak patterns. These spatial analysis techniques proved invaluable for policymakers seeking to allocate resources and implement targeted interventions.

2.2 Existing Predictive Models and Analytical Approaches

Beyond descriptive analysis, a substantial body of research has focused on predicting the future trajectory of the pandemic. These predictive models can be broadly categorized into epidemiological models and data-driven machine learning models.

Epidemiological models, particularly the SIR (Susceptible-Infected-Recovered) and SEIR (Susceptible-Exposed-Infected-Recovered) frameworks, were among the first to be applied to COVID-

19 data. These compartmental models divide the population into distinct groups based on infection status and simulate the flow of individuals between states over time. While mathematically elegant and theoretically grounded, their accuracy depends heavily on assumptions about transmission rates, incubation periods, and population behavior—parameters that proved difficult to estimate reliably during a novel and evolving pandemic.

Regression-based approaches, including linear and polynomial regression, were applied to model case growth during specific phases of the pandemic. These models offered simplicity and interpretability but struggled to capture the nonlinear, sudden changes in case trajectories caused by factors such as lockdowns, new variants, or vaccination drives. Their predictive accuracy was therefore limited to short time windows under stable conditions.

More sophisticated statistical methods, such as ARIMA (AutoRegressive Integrated Moving Average) and its seasonal variant SARIMA, were employed to model time-series patterns in case data. These methods performed reasonably well on short-term forecasting tasks but required stationarity assumptions and were sensitive to sudden structural breaks in the data—a common occurrence during the pandemic.

2.3 Comparative Study of Machine Learning Models

The rapid advancement of machine learning created an opportunity to apply a variety of supervised and unsupervised learning models to COVID-19 prediction and classification tasks. Numerous studies have compared the performance of these models, offering insights into their relative strengths and weaknesses in the context of pandemic data.

Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks, a variant of recurrent neural networks designed to capture long-range temporal dependencies, emerged as one of the most widely studied models for COVID-19 case forecasting. Studies reported that LSTM models outperformed traditional statistical models like ARIMA on longer forecast horizons, particularly when trained on sufficiently large and consistent time-series data. However, they required significant computational resources and were prone to overfitting on small national-level datasets.

Random Forest and Gradient Boosting models, including XGBoost, were applied to classification and feature importance tasks—such as identifying which demographic or healthcare variables most strongly predicted high mortality rates. These ensemble methods demonstrated strong performance on tabular datasets and provided interpretable feature rankings, making them popular in epidemiological research despite not being inherently designed for sequential data.

Support Vector Machines (SVM) and logistic regression were used in several studies for binary classification tasks, such as predicting whether a country would experience a second wave based on its early response indicators. While these models offered computational efficiency and interpretability, their performance was generally lower than that of deep learning approaches on complex, high-dimensional datasets.

A comparative study by Zeroual et al. (2020) evaluated five deep learning models—RNN, LSTM, Bidirectional LSTM, GRU, and VAE—on COVID-19 case prediction across multiple countries. Their findings consistently showed that LSTM and GRU models delivered the best predictive accuracy. Such studies underscore the importance of model selection and the trade-off between model complexity, data availability, and forecasting accuracy.

2.4 Limitations of Existing Systems

Despite the breadth and depth of existing research, several notable limitations persist across both analytical tools and predictive systems developed during the pandemic. A critical review of the literature reveals the following key gaps:

- **Lack of Accessibility for Non-Technical Users:** The majority of COVID-19 analysis tools and dashboards were designed with data scientists and researchers in mind. They often require programming knowledge, familiarity with statistical methods, or access to specialized software. This creates a significant accessibility barrier for the general public, journalists, and policymakers who may lack technical expertise but need to interpret pandemic data to make informed decisions.
- **Limited Interactivity and Customization:** Many existing dashboards, including some government-run portals, present static or semi-static visualizations. Users are unable to filter by specific countries, adjust date ranges, or compare multiple regions side by side. This inflexibility reduces the practical utility of these platforms for personalized data exploration.
- **Over-reliance on Predictive Complexity Without Explainability:** Several research systems prioritized prediction accuracy over interpretability. Complex deep learning models, while accurate, often function as black boxes, making it difficult for stakeholders to understand or trust the results. This is particularly problematic in public health settings where transparency and trust are essential.
- **Data Quality and Inconsistency Issues:** Many systems failed to adequately address inconsistencies in the underlying data, such as retrospective corrections, underreporting in certain regions, and missing values. Without robust preprocessing

pipelines, these issues propagated into analyses and undermined the reliability of insights.

- **Scalability and Maintenance Challenges:** A number of projects were developed as one-time research efforts tied to a specific snapshot of data. They lacked mechanisms for regular updates, making them quickly outdated as the pandemic evolved. The absence of scalable architectures limited their long-term usefulness.

These limitations collectively highlight the need for a solution that prioritizes simplicity, accessibility, interactivity, and data integrity—without attempting to compete with complex predictive systems. The COVID-19 Data Analysis and Visualization Dashboard developed in this project directly addresses these gaps by focusing on clear visual storytelling, robust preprocessing, and an intuitive interface accessible to all users.

CHAPTER 3: SYSTEM ANALYSIS AND DESIGN

This chapter presents a comprehensive analysis and design of the COVID-19 Data Analysis and Visualization Dashboard. It describes the system overview, the dataset used, the data preprocessing pipeline, the architectural structure of the system, and the key UML and flow diagrams that define the system's behavior and interactions.

3.1 System Overview

The proposed system is a web-based interactive dashboard built using Python and Streamlit. It is designed to ingest structured COVID-19 data, process and clean it through an automated preprocessing pipeline, perform exploratory data analysis, and present the results through dynamic visualizations. The system targets non-technical users and provides an intuitive interface with dropdown filters and date-range selectors.

The system operates in a five-layer architecture: Data Layer, Processing Layer, Analysis Layer, Visualization Layer, and Presentation Layer. Each layer has a well-defined role, ensuring modularity and ease of maintenance. The system runs as a local Streamlit web application and does not require any internet connection after the dataset is loaded.

3.2 Dataset Description

The dataset used in this project is sourced from the Johns Hopkins University Center for Systems Science and Engineering (JHU CSSE) COVID-19 public repository. It is one of the most widely cited and trusted datasets in pandemic research and contains daily records of confirmed cases, recoveries, and deaths across more than 180 countries and territories.

The dataset includes the following key attributes:

- **Date:** The calendar date of the recorded data point, spanning from January 2020 onwards.
- **Country/Region:** The name of the country or territory for which data is recorded.
- **Confirmed Cases:** The cumulative count of laboratory-confirmed COVID-19 cases.
- **Recovered Cases:** The cumulative count of individuals who recovered from the virus.
- **Deaths:** The cumulative count of COVID-19-related fatalities.

The dataset is stored in CSV format and is loaded directly into a Pandas DataFrame for processing. It is regularly updated and widely used across academic and public health research contexts, ensuring reliability and completeness.

3.3 Data Preprocessing

Raw data from the source often contains inconsistencies, missing entries, and formatting irregularities that must be resolved before meaningful analysis can be performed. The preprocessing pipeline implemented in this project addresses these issues through the following steps:

- **Missing Value Handling:** Rows with null or NaN values in critical columns such as confirmed cases or deaths are either filled using forward-fill methods or removed, depending on the extent of the gap.
- **Date Formatting:** The date column is parsed and converted to Python datetime objects using Pandas to_datetime() function, enabling time-series operations and filtering.
- **Column Normalization:** Column names are standardized to lowercase with underscores to ensure consistency across all modules.
- **Data Aggregation:** Country-level data is aggregated by summing province/state-level entries where applicable, producing a single record per country per date.
- **Derived Metrics Calculation:** New daily case counts, daily deaths, and daily recoveries are computed from cumulative figures using the Pandas diff() function.

3.4 Model Architecture

Since this project focuses on data analysis and visualization rather than prediction, no machine learning model is employed. The architecture instead consists of a modular Python-based system with

five core classes: DataLoader, DataPreprocessor, EDAAnalyzer, Visualizer, and Dashboard. Each class encapsulates a specific responsibility, following object-oriented design principles to ensure clean separation of concerns and reusability.

The DataLoader class is responsible for reading the CSV file and returning a validated Pandas DataFrame. The DataPreprocessor handles all cleaning and transformation operations. The EDAAnalyzer performs statistical analysis and pattern detection. The Visualizer class generates all chart types using Matplotlib and Seaborn. Finally, the Dashboard class manages the Streamlit interface, including filter controls and chart rendering.

3.5 Training Strategy

As no predictive model is used in this project, there is no formal training phase or model optimization involved. Instead, the system's analytical accuracy depends on the quality of preprocessing and the correctness of the data transformations applied. The strategy adopted is one of incremental validation: each preprocessing step is tested independently using unit assertions to ensure that the output DataFrame meets expected schema, value ranges, and completeness criteria before being passed to the next module.

This validation-first approach serves as a functional substitute for model training in a pure data analysis context. It ensures that the pipeline is robust, reproducible, and produces consistent outputs regardless of the input file version.

3.6 System Architecture Diagram

The table below illustrates the five-layer architecture of the system, mapping each layer to its component, technology, and role within the pipeline.

Layer	Component	Technology	Role
Data Layer	Dataset (CSV)	Johns Hopkins Repo	Raw data source
Processing Layer	Preprocessing Engine	Pandas / NumPy	Clean & transform data
Analysis Layer	EDA Module	Pandas / Seaborn	Trend & pattern analysis
Visualization Layer	Chart Generator	Matplotlib / Seaborn	Produce graphs & plots
Presentation Layer	Dashboard Interface	Streamlit	Interactive UI for users

Table 3.1 – System Architecture Overview

3.7 Flow Diagram

The following flow diagram illustrates the sequential steps the system follows from data loading to final dashboard output, including the user interaction stage.

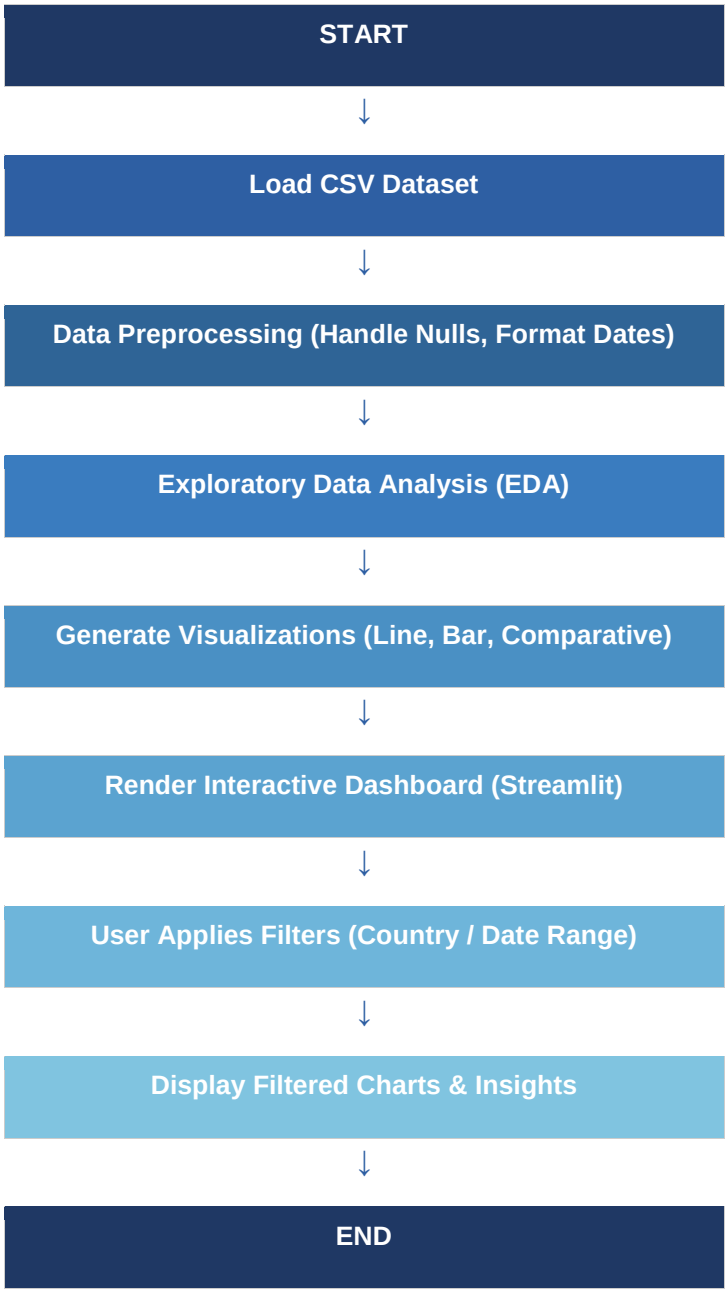

Figure 3.1 – System Flow Diagram

3.8 UML Diagrams

3.8.1 Use Case Diagram

The use case diagram identifies the primary interactions between the end user and the system. The following table captures all major use cases, the responsible actor, and a brief description of each interaction.

UC ID	Use Case	Actor	Description
UC-01	View Dashboard	End User	User opens the Streamlit dashboard to view COVID-19 visualizations
UC-02	Filter by Country	End User	User selects a specific country from the dropdown menu
UC-03	Filter by Date Range	End User	User sets a custom start and end date to narrow the data view
UC-04	View Line Chart	End User	System renders a time-series line graph for selected parameters
UC-05	Compare Regions	End User	User compares case trends across two or more countries
UC-06	Load & Preprocess Data	System	System loads CSV, handles nulls and formats data automatically on startup

Table 3.2 – Use Case Descriptions

3.8.2 Class Diagram

The class diagram below defines the five core classes of the system, their attributes, methods, and responsibilities. This structure reflects the object-oriented design of the system's Python codebase.

Class	Attributes	Methods	Responsibility
`DataLoader`	`filepath: str df: DataFrame`	`load_data() validate()`	`Reads CSV and validates schema`

`DataPreprocessor`	`df: DataFrame`	`handle_nulls()`
		`format_dates()`
		`normalize()`
			`Cleans and prepares raw data`

`EDAAnalyzer`	`df: DataFrame`	`summary_stats()`
		`correlation_map()`
		`detect_peaks()`
			`Performs exploratory analysis`

`Visualizer`	`df: DataFrame`
	`country: str`
	`date_range: tuple`
		`line_chart() bar_chart()`
		`comparative_plot()`
			`Generates all chart types`

`Dashboard`	`title: str` `filters: dict`	`render() apply_filters()` `update_view()`	`Streamlit UI controller`

Table 3.3 – Class Diagram Summary

3.8.3 Sequence Diagram

The sequence diagram illustrates the order of interactions between system components when a user opens the dashboard and applies a country filter. Each step represents a method call or data transfer between objects.

Step	User	Dashboard	DataLoader	Preprocessor	Visualizer
1	Opens app	Initializes UI			
2		Calls load_data()	Reads CSV file		
3			Returns DataFrame	Cleans & formats	
4	Selects country	Passes filter params			
5				Filters data	Renders charts
6	Views output	Displays charts			

Table 3.4 – Sequence Diagram (User Filter Interaction)

CHAPTER 4: CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

This chapter brings together the outcomes of the COVID-19 Data Analysis and Visualization Dashboard project. It provides a consolidated summary of the work carried out, presents the key findings derived from the data analysis, reflects on the project's contributions, and outlines a set of meaningful enhancements that could extend its capabilities in future iterations.

4.1 Summary of Work

This project set out with a clear and purposeful goal: to transform large, complex COVID-19 datasets into accessible, interactive visualizations that any user — regardless of technical background — could explore and understand. Over the course of the project, each phase of this goal was methodically addressed, from data collection and preprocessing through to exploratory analysis and dashboard deployment.

The journey began with the acquisition of the Johns Hopkins University COVID-19 dataset, a globally recognized and widely used repository of pandemic records. This dataset, containing daily counts of confirmed cases, recoveries, and deaths across more than 180 countries, was loaded into a Python environment and subjected to a rigorous preprocessing pipeline. Missing values were handled through forward-fill strategies, date fields were standardized, data was aggregated at the country level, and derived daily metrics were computed to reveal granular trends hidden within cumulative figures.

With clean data in hand, exploratory data analysis was conducted to uncover patterns, peaks, and regional differences in pandemic progression. These insights were then translated into a suite of visualizations — line graphs tracing case trajectories over time, bar charts comparing country-level statistics, and comparative plots highlighting differences in outbreak severity and recovery performance. All visualizations were designed with clarity and simplicity in mind, prioritizing readability over complexity.

The final and most visible output of the project was the interactive Streamlit dashboard. This user-facing interface brought all the analysis together in a single, cohesive platform. Users could select their country of interest, define a custom date range, and observe real-time chart updates — all without writing a single line of code. The dashboard fulfilled its core design objective: to serve as a bridge between raw pandemic data and the people who need to understand it.

Component	Implementation	Outcome
Data Source	Johns Hopkins University CSV repository	Reliable, multi-country pandemic dataset
Preprocessing	Pandas / NumPy pipeline	Clean, consistent, analysis-ready data
Analysis	Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)	Identified trends, peaks, and recovery patterns
Visualization	Matplotlib & Seaborn charts	Line graphs, bar charts, comparative plots
Dashboard	Streamlit interactive interface	User-friendly, filterable, real-time UI

Table 4.1 – Project Component Summary

In terms of technical learning, this project provided hands-on experience with the complete data science workflow — from raw data ingestion to a polished, deployable product. It demonstrated that impactful data analysis does not always require machine learning or predictive modeling; well-

designed visualization and thoughtful preprocessing can independently deliver significant value and insight.

4.2 Key Findings

The analysis of the COVID-19 dataset revealed several significant findings that shed light on the nature and progression of the pandemic. These findings were drawn from time-series trends, regional comparisons, and daily delta metrics computed during the exploratory data analysis phase.

One of the most prominent observations was the exponential growth in confirmed case counts during the early phases of the pandemic, particularly between March and May 2020. This rapid escalation — visible across nearly every major country — highlighted the critical importance of real-time monitoring systems and early intervention strategies. The visualizations made this trend unmistakably clear, even to users with no statistical background.

A second key finding was the presence of distinct wave patterns across countries, with surges occurring at different times and with varying intensities. While some nations experienced their most severe outbreaks in the first wave, others faced far greater case loads during subsequent waves driven by new variants. This temporal variation underscored the importance of country-level filtering in the dashboard, allowing users to study each nation's unique trajectory rather than being misled by global aggregates.

The analysis also revealed substantial differences in recovery-to-death ratios across countries. Nations with stronger healthcare infrastructure and faster testing capacity consistently reported higher recovery rates relative to fatalities. Conversely, regions with limited medical resources or delayed reporting showed disproportionately high mortality figures, reflecting both real disparities and data quality challenges.

#	Key Finding	Insight
1	Exponential case growth in early pandemic phases	Rapid escalation underscores importance of early monitoring
2	Distinct wave patterns across countries	Different nations experienced varied surge timelines
3	High variance in recovery-to-death ratios	Healthcare capacity significantly impacted outcomes

4	Visible impact of lockdowns on daily case counts	Policy interventions produced measurable inflection points
5	Data gaps and underreporting in certain regions	Highlights need for robust preprocessing pipelines

Table 4.2 – Summary of Key Findings

Perhaps the most practically significant finding was the visible impact of government policy interventions — particularly lockdowns and movement restrictions — on daily case counts. In multiple countries, sharp inflection points in the case trajectory coincided precisely with the announcement of containment measures, providing compelling visual evidence of policy effectiveness. This finding reinforces the value of visualization tools in making policy-outcome relationships tangible and communicable to the public.

4.3 Future Enhancements

While the current version of the dashboard successfully meets its design objectives, several enhancements could significantly expand its utility, reach, and analytical depth. The following directions represent natural and well-motivated extensions of the existing system.

- **Real-Time Data Integration:** The dashboard currently relies on a static CSV file, which requires manual updates to reflect the latest data. Integrating live data feeds from sources such as the WHO API or the JHU live repository would enable the dashboard to display up-to-date statistics automatically, transforming it from a historical analysis tool into a live monitoring platform.
- **Predictive Analytics Module:** Introducing a forecasting layer using time-series models such as ARIMA, Prophet, or LSTM neural networks would allow the dashboard to project future case trends based on historical patterns. This would add significant analytical value, particularly for public health planners and researchers seeking to anticipate the trajectory of ongoing or future outbreaks.
- **Cloud Deployment:** Deploying the dashboard on a cloud platform such as Streamlit Community Cloud, AWS Elastic Beanstalk, or Heroku would make it publicly accessible via a web browser, removing the requirement for local Python installation and dramatically broadening its potential user base.
- **Vaccination Data Integration:** Incorporating vaccination coverage data from sources such as Our World in Data would enable the dashboard to visually correlate vaccination rollout timelines with changes in case counts, deaths, and hospitalization rates — providing a richer, multi-dimensional picture of the pandemic response.

- **Mobile-Responsive Interface:** Redesigning the dashboard layout with responsive CSS or migrating to a React-based frontend would ensure that the interface renders correctly and remains fully usable on smartphones and tablets, addressing a significant accessibility gap in the current design.
- **Multi-Language Support:** Adding internationalization (i18n) support would allow the dashboard to be displayed in multiple languages, making it accessible to a global audience and increasing its relevance in non-English-speaking regions most affected by the pandemic.

#	Enhancement	Technology / Approach	Expected Benefit
1	Real-time data integration	REST APIs / WHO / JHU live feed	Always up-to-date dashboard
2	Predictive analytics module	LSTM / ARIMA forecasting models	Future trend projection
3	Cloud deployment	Streamlit Cloud / AWS / Heroku	Global accessibility via browser
4	Multi-language support	i18n localization framework	Wider international usability
5	Mobile-responsive UI	Responsive CSS / React Native	Access on smartphones and tablets
6	Vaccination data integration	Our World in Data API	Correlate vaccines with case trends

Table 4.3 – Proposed Future Enhancements

In closing, the COVID-19 Data Analysis and Visualization Dashboard stands as a demonstration of how thoughtfully applied data science can make complex, high-stakes information genuinely accessible. At a time when public understanding of health data has never been more important, tools like this one play a meaningful role in bridging the gap between raw numbers and human comprehension. The project lays a solid foundation upon which future enhancements can build — evolving from a data exploration tool into a comprehensive, real-time public health intelligence platform.